

CHANGES IN PERSPECTIVE

Shifting who is telling the story



1 What is it?

Changes In Perspective

A change in perspective shifts **who is telling the story**, or through whose eyes events are seen — giving the reader a new viewpoint on the same events.

narrator A's view → narrator B's view

2 See it in action

Multiple narrators

One chapter is told from the hero's point of view, the next from the villain's.

First to third person

A story shifts from intimate "I" narration to a distant, observing narrator.

Unreliable narrator revealed

A later perspective shows the first narrator was wrong or lying all along.

Same event, different eyes

The exact same argument is shown from both people's point of view.



Look here!

When the perspective shifts, ask: **what does this new narrator know or feel that the last one didn't?** That gap is where the real meaning lives.

FUN FACT

Some novels are built entirely around shifting perspective — like a story told through several different characters' diary entries, forcing the reader to piece together the "real" truth themselves.

3 Why writers use it

Changes In Perspective helps writers: reveal information the first narrator couldn't or wouldn't share, build sympathy for multiple characters, and let the reader see the gap between how different people experience the same event.

A perspective shift is one of the most powerful tools for building irony — the reader often knows more than any single character, because they've seen the story from every angle.

4 Don't mix it up!

Changes in Perspective

- Changes **who** narrates
- A shift in point of view
- Reveals new information

Shifts in Focus

- Changes **what** is looked at
- Same narrator, new subject
- A zoom in or zoom out



Watch out!

Don't assume a change in perspective always means a new narrator speaking directly — it can also be a third-person narrator who moves closer to a different character's thoughts and feelings.



You got this!

Watch for moments where two perspectives **contradict** each other — that's often a deliberate clue that one narrator is unreliable.

5 Quick recap

Shifts who tells the story

Gives a new viewpoint

Can reveal hidden information



Good spot!

Try writing the same short argument twice — once from each person's point of view. Notice how differently the "same" event can be told.